

Contributing Guidelines

The short version — what to do before you open a PR.

Read this if: everyone

Branches

```
main = stable · develop = integration · feature/* = individual work
```

Never push directly to `main`.

Before you start

Read, in order: Build Specification, PRD, API Contract, Database Design, Team Workflow, Team Assignments.

Ownership

Stay inside your assigned module unless another member has agreed to the change.

Pull requests

Feature branches merge into `develop`. Every PR states what changed, how it was tested, whether any API or schema changed, and what it depends on from other modules.

Secrets

Never commit `.env`, API keys, tokens, or passwords. Use `.env.example` to document variable names only — never real values.